

TEN SCORES

The Path To **Lower** Google
Adwords Costs And **Higher**
Ad Exposure

by Chris Thunder

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Website: www.TenScores.com

Preface

My first 10 score was like magic.

A keyword that was costing me \$0.25 per click on average dropped to \$0.13. My return on investment soared and I sang Google melodies and praises till my neighbors told me to quit it!

It was a nice day.

I realized I was over-paying for all the other keywords that didn't have 10 scores. That's when my search for excellence in regards to adwords advertising begun.

It's been a rough journey.

It cost me a lot of money, time and energy learning what you're about to learn in this book. My deepest hope is that you get ten times the value of your investment applying the concepts in 10 Scores... if not more.

To get the most out of it, read through it once without skipping a chapter nor an appendix. Take notes on areas you were not aware of and come back to those sections when you encounter difficulties with Quality Score.

Enjoy!

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I'm a computer geek, I regularly and actively search the internet for people who violate my copyrights. My attorney would love to make you regret it if such a stupid idea ever crossed your mind.

If you do evil, we will find you!

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Table Of Content

Preface	
Chapter 1 - An Introduction By Quality Score	7
The adwords ad auction	9
First Page Minimum Bids	14
Impression Share	16
Content Network	17
Other	17
Conclusion	18
 Chapter 2 - The 5 Commandments	 22
I Have Great Account History	23
II Have Great Domain History	25
III Have Relevant & “High Quality” Pages	28
IV Structure Ad Groups By Ad Content	35
V Get The Highest CTRs	39

Chapter 3 - Higher CTRs With Irresistible Ads	42
1 Understand Words, Images & Emotions	42
2 Understand Features & Benefits	43
3 Understand The Disco Dance	44
4 Never Run Out Of Ads	47
5 The Conversion Rate vs CTR Dilemma	52
6 The Competition Works For You	54
Winning Ads Step-By-Step	56
 Chapter 4 - Higher CTRs With Better Targeting	 58
Rule 1 - Choose Specific Keywords	59
Rule 2 - Be Specific In Campaign Settings	60
 Final Words	 62
 Appendix A Customizing Columns	
Appendix B Landing Page Relevance	
Appendix C Spying On Competitors For Free	
Appendix D Chatting With Official Adwords Reps	

AN INTRODUCTION BY
Quality Score



Keyword	Status ?	Max. CPC	Qual. Score	Clicks	Impr.	CTR ?	Avg. CPC ?	Cost
truth about abs	Rarely shown due to low quality score	CA\$1.50	1/10	9	278	3.24%	CA\$0.82	CA\$7.39
[truth about abs]	Rarely shown due to low quality score	CA\$1.50	1/10	6	249	2.41%	CA\$0.94	CA\$5.66
[the truth about six pack abs]	Rarely shown due to low quality score	CA\$1.50	1/10	4	254	1.57%	CA\$0.83	CA\$3.32
[truth about six pack abs]	Status ?	Max. CPC	Qual. Score					93 CA\$0.93
[truth about 6 pack abs]	Rarely shown due to low quality score	CA\$1.50	1/10					92 CA\$0.92

I don't care who you are, who you've been or who you'll be. I don't care how rich or poor you are, I don't care what your reasons are for advertising online... If you ignore me, I will sack you!

Ignore me and you'll have a hard time advertising with Google. Ignore me and your Adwords costs will skyrocket. Ignore me and your ads will never make it anywhere on the web.

I'm capricious, hard to tame and I change moods all the time.

Some say I'm high maintenance... I say I just have high standards and I long for quality. My name is Quality Score.

Most know me as a round number that ranges from 1 to 10, but in reality I have numerous decimals that you can't see, along with other details that you need not know.

* See Appendix A to learn how to make a Quality Score column visible for your keywords and an Impression Share column visible for your campaigns.

If you haven't made me visible in your Adwords account yet, I suggest you do it right away (see *appendix A*). While you're at it, make sure you make "Impression Share" visible too. We're going to have one hell of a relationship... just don't make me mad or you'll regret it!

I have sweeping effects in your adwords account, some you probably don't even suspect.

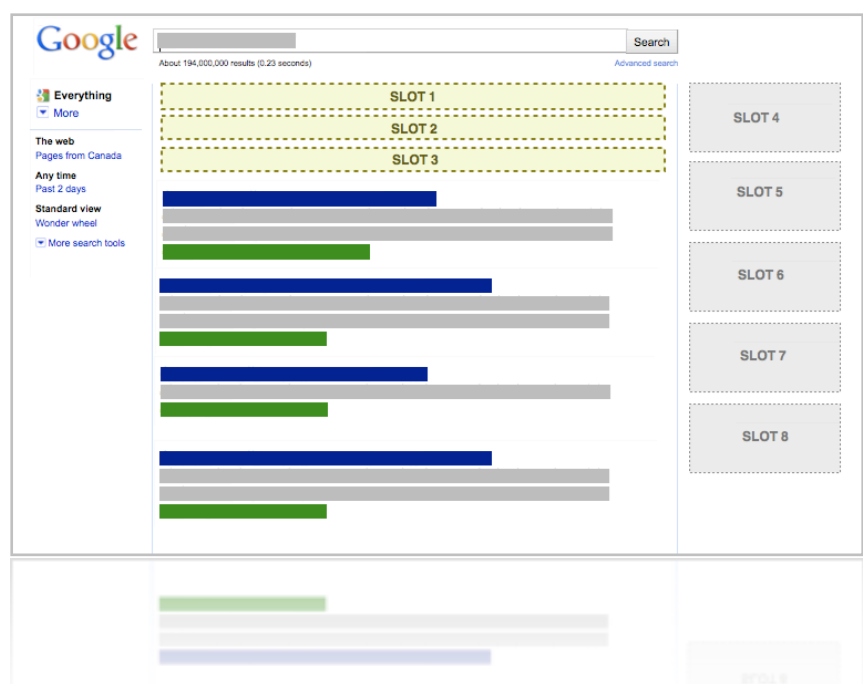
You may think I'm complicated, but I'm really not.

I was born to help Google achieve its mission of providing valuable sponsored results to the millions of users who trust the search engine everyday.

To help you understand me better and learn the impacts I have on your adwords account you'll need to understand the Adwords ad auction, Ad Rank and Actual CPC.

THE ADWORDS AD AUCTION

Every time a search query is performed on Google, an ad auction is run for the 8 slots (sometimes 11) available for ads.



First Google has to assess which ads are eligible to be shown. Once ads worthy of getting a placement have been chosen, Google decides which position each ad should have.

Let's use an example with 10 advertisers and 8 slots available.

Simplified version of the ad auction

In a simplified ad auction, positions would be granted based on each advertiser's bid, the highest bidder getting position 1, the second highest bidder getting position 2 and so forth. Since there are 10 advertisers and only 8 slots available, the 2 lowest bidders would not be eligible to enter the auction.

This is an auction for clicks, so advertisers only pay when they receive a click. They don't actually pay the amount they bid, rather they pay just enough to beat the advertiser bidding below them.

The actual cost-per-click (actual CPC) is the next advertiser's bid plus 1 cent:

$$\text{Actual CPC} = \text{Next Advertiser's Bid} + \$0.01 \quad (1)$$

As illustrated in Fig 1 on the next page, Bill is the highest bidder in our example so his ad gets top position, Chris and John's bids are too low to enter the auction.

The problem with such an auction is that any advertiser - of quality or not - can pay his way up the hierarchy and simply get better position by increasing his bids.

		Bid	Actual CPC
Slot 1	Bill	\$5.00	\$4.01
Slot 2	Hillary	\$4.00	\$3.76
Slot 3	Barrack	\$3.75	\$3.46
Slot 4	Joe	\$3.45	\$3.01
Slot 5	Dennis	\$3.00	\$2.51
Slot 6	Fred	\$2.50	\$1.71
Slot 7	Evan	\$1.70	\$1.01
Slot 8	Tom	\$1.00	\$0.51
	Chris	\$0.50	-
	John	\$0.20	-

Fig 1. Simple version of the ad auction

Ads are ranked by order of higher bidder, each bidder only actually pays enough to keep his position which is the next advertiser's bid plus \$0.01.

Real version of the Adwords ad auction

In reality, ads are not ranked by advertiser's bids but by advertiser's Ad Rank. Ad Rank is calculated by multiplying an advertisers' bid (also known as max. CPC) by his Quality Score:

$$\text{Ad Rank} = \text{maxCPC} \times \text{QS} \quad (2)$$

And the actual cost-per-click is determined by the the next advertiser's Ad Rank divided by your Quality Score plus 1 cent:

$$\text{Actual CPC} = \frac{\text{Next advertiser's Ad Rank}}{\text{Your QS}} + \$0.01 \quad (3)$$

Do not be intimidated by the math, what's important are the final results that the system yields.

As shown in Fig. 2 on the next page, this changes dynamics completely. Bill can no longer pay his way to the top, instead he gets position 5 and pays a higher price than Barrack who's in position 1 with his 10/10 Quality Score.

Chris who wasn't eligible to enter the ad auction with his low \$0.50 bid is now able to secure position 8 and only pay \$0.19 per click.

Yes, the Quality Score game is discriminatory and punishes low quality advertisers while rewarding those who know the rules.

Congratulations for getting your hands on this book, you have the tools to win!

		Bid x QS = Ad Rank			Actual CPC
Slot 1	Barrack	\$3.75	10	37.5	\$2.81
Slot 2	Hillary	\$4.00	8	32	\$3.46
Slot 3	Joe	\$3.45	7	24.15	\$2.58
Slot 4	Dennis	\$3.00	6	18	\$2.51
Slot 5	Bill	\$5.00	3	15	\$3.34
Slot 6	Fred	\$2.50	4	10	\$2.13
Slot 7	Evan	\$1.70	5	8.5	\$0.91
Slot 8	Chris	\$0.50	9	4.5	\$0.19
	John	\$0.20	8	1.6	-
	Tom	\$1.00	1	1	-

Fig 2. Real version of the Adwords ad auction

Advertisers ads are ranked by their Ad Rank, the highest bidder no longer gets the highest position, and the price they pay largely depends on the quality of their advertising. The two last advertiser's Ad Ranks are too low, they'll see the following message in their adwords account: *below first page bid*

So far you’ve learned how Quality Score affects Ad Rank (position) on the search results and most importantly, advertising costs.

A slight increase or decrease in QS can go a very long way. Imagine getting a 1000 clicks a day. Paying \$0.10 more per click means \$100 more in daily advertising expenses. On the other hand lowering your costs-per-click by \$0.10 only, means \$100 in daily savings.

But that’s just the tip of the ice-berg, Quality Score effects go far beyond.

In our example, John and Tom’s Ad Ranks where too low to enter the auction. In reality, it is the auction on the first page of *Google.com* that their ads are not eligible to show.

Just like the natural search results, there can be many pages for sponsored results. If an advertiser’s Ad Rank is too low, his ad will still be displayed but not on the first page.

Which brings us to the third main thing Quality Score has impact on, which is: *first page min bid*.

FIRST PAGE MINIMUM BID

Keyword	Status ?	Max. CPC	Qual. Score
[watch the secret]	 Below first page bid First page bid estimate: CA\$1.20	CA\$0.50 	3/10

A low or high Quality Score can determine whether your ad ever reaches the first page of Google’s sponsored results.

Our example in Fig 2 shows that there’s a min Ad Rank an advertiser must have to enter the auction, which is Chris’s Ad Rank of 4.5. John and Tom are left out of the first page because they don’t have the required Ad Rank to compete with other players.

From the formula of Ad Rank (2) can be derived a formula for *minimum ad rank*, from which we get a formula for *minimum bid*:

$$\text{min. Ad Rank} = \text{min. bid} \times \text{QS}^*$$

$$\text{min. bid} = \text{min. Ad Rank} / \text{QS}^*$$

(4)

Again, do not worry about the math if it isn't your thing.

A minimum Ad Rank is specific to each ad auction and a minimum bid is specific to each advertiser. The minimum bid depends on the competition and your Quality Score. You have no control on competition, you have a large degree of control on Quality Score.

Table 1 shows the the humongous difference between John and Tom's minimum bids in the same ad auction with their respective Quality Scores.

	QS	min. Ad Rank	min bid
John	8	4.5	\$0.56 OK
Tom	1	4.5	\$4.5 KO

Table 1 . First page min. bid

John only needs to raise his bid to \$0.56 to enter the auction while Tom would need to bid a whooping \$4.5 (just to get the last ad spot).

You do not want to be Tom. And being John isn't the absolute best scenario either. If John managed to increase his Quality Score to 10, his min first page bid would be around \$0.45.

* These formulas - unlike the ones for Ad Rank and Actual CPC - have not been officially confirmed by Google. The actual formula for minimum bid might be slightly different.

Quick recap, Quality Score controls:

- Your ad's position through *Ad Rank*
- Your advertising costs through *Actual CPC*
- If your ad ever shows through *first page min. bid*

Those are the 3 main areas touched by it.

Here are more...

IMPRESSION SHARE

Campaign	Budget	Status	Clicks	Impr.	CTR	Avg. CPC	Cost	Conv. rate (1-per-click)	Impr. Share	Lost Impr. Share (Budget)	Lost Impr. Share (Rank)
GSK - Search	\$10.00/day	Eligible	91,111	8,180,126	1.11%	\$0.20	\$18,352.41	1.68%	53.37%	4.82%	41.80%
HKY - Search	\$5.00/day	Eligible	48,702	2,915,086	1.67%	\$0.17	\$8,253.65	1.46%	36.59%	3.83%	59.59%
H S									62.95%	0.00%	37.05%
Impr. Share Lost Impr. Share (Budget) Lost Impr. Share (Rank)											
				53.37%					4.82%		
				36.59%					3.83%		
				62.95%					0.00%		

Impression share is the percentage of times your ad is shown for all queries that could trigger it. Go to *appendix A* to learn how to view it in your account, you'll be able to see your current Impression Share and where you've been losing some of that exposure (budget or ad rank).

Impression share is directly influenced by Ad Rank and indirectly influenced by Quality Score since Ad Rank depends on Quality Score.

Increasing Quality Score increases Ad Rank which increases Impression Share which increases the number of clicks you receive, which means more traffic which means more revenue.

CONTENT NETWORK

The discussion above has been about Quality Score on the search network, which is the home page of Google.com and Google’s search partners (AOL, Youtube, Ask.com, and other search engines).

There is a Quality Score for content network sites (non-search sites). Unlike the search Quality Score, content network Quality Score is not viewable anywhere in your account (Google likes to keep secrets). However, it has very much the same impacts on your advertising as has the search Quality Score.

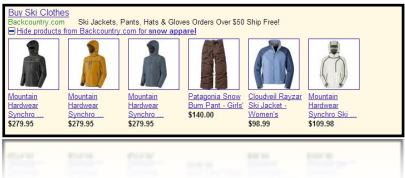
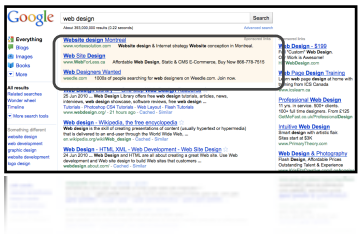
In addition to your ad’s position, your cost-per-click and Impression Share on the content network, Quality Score controls:

- If your ad is eligible to show on a keyword-targeted content network page.
- If your ad is eligible to show on a placement-targeted page.

OTHER

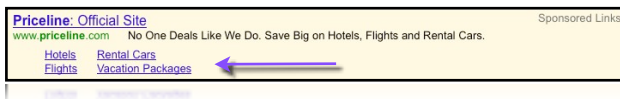
As if that wasn’t enough, this little metric also determines:

- If your ad is eligible to be shown in the top spots just above the search results. There’s a threshold for those spots and even advertisers who boost their Ad Rank by bidding high will not get them unless they meet the Quality Score requirements.
- Whether product extensions can be displayed with your ad. Did you know your search ad can contain images of your products along with other information? Sorry, not if your Quality Score is too low.



Note: Product extensions are currently only available in the USA and to certain types of advertisers. [Click here to learn more.](#)

- Whether site links can be displayed with your ad or not. Did you know your ad could be shown with various links to different pages of your website? Sorry, not if your Quality Score is too low.



Note: The Site Links feature only appears in advertiser's accounts who have met the quality requirement.
[Click here to learn more](#)

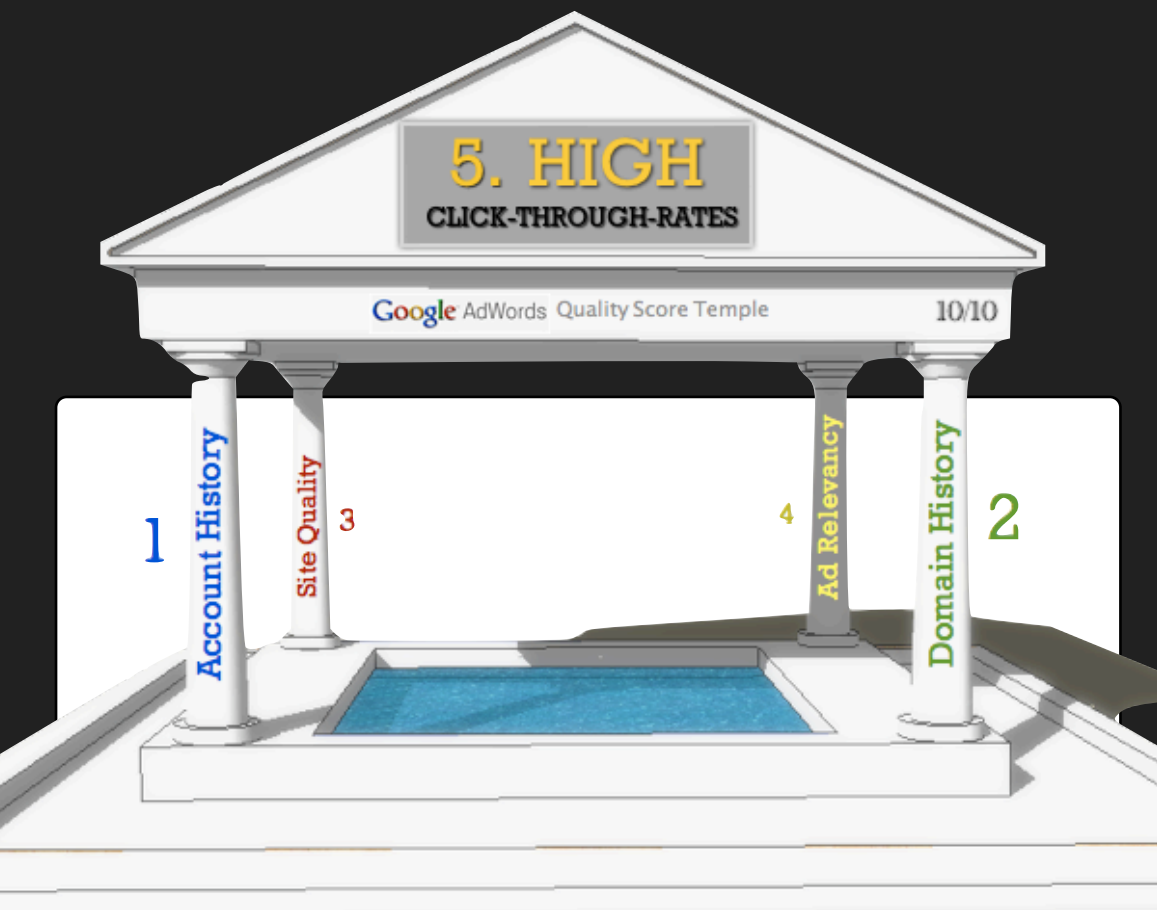
CONCLUSION

Don't mess with Quality Score!

Hopefully that has sank deep within you and you're ready to pay close and focused attention to the pages that follow. On any keyword or content site that has proven to make you money, it is not enough to just have good Quality Scores...

... you must have above average scores of 10/10, and that's what the next pages are all about!

THE QUALITY SCORE
Temple



For this temple to be a good shelter, it needs a roof and 4 pillars. The roof is the most important component as it creates the protection. But remove one of the four pillars and the building collapses. The four pillars alone do not make the temple and the roof on it's own is a just a roof.

Quality Score has 5 elements that relate to each other just like this temple's roof and four pillars. The roof is your ad's click-through-rates and the four pillars are: account history, domain history, relevance and site quality. Click-through-rates are the most important factors of high Quality Scores whether on the search network or content network. But they cannot stand without the four pillars. Remove any of the pillars and you'll have almost no chance of achieving 10/10 Quality Scores.

The first pillar - account history - is given to you by default when you open a new adwords account. You can make it stronger or damage it.

The second pillar - domain history - is given to you as well when you have a fresh domain.

The only thing that can happen to those two at the beginning is get stronger or get damaged. It's up to you to make sure they do not deteriorate, otherwise the whole structure of your Quality Score temple will be corrupted.

If your account history has been deteriorated, you'll need to fix it or replace it by getting a new account. Most of the time, it's better to start fresh with a new account.

If your domain history has been deteriorated, you'll need to fix it or replace it by getting a new domain. In most cases, you're better off getting a new domain.

You're about to learn the 5 commandments to having 10/10 Quality Scores. Each one of the commandments have to do with one component of the Quality Score Temple... what it's made of, how to make it stronger and how to fix it if it has been damaged.



THE 5 COMMANDMENTS TO 10/10 QUALITY SCORES

- I. Have great account history
- II. Have great domain history
- III. Have relevant & “high quality” landing pages
- IV. Structure your ad groups by ad content not keywords
- V. Get higher click-through-rates than competitors

These 5 commandments are a mirror image of the Quality Score temple. If you have a new account and a new domain, commandments I and II will take care of themselves *if and only if* you follow commandments III, IV and V to the letter.

Commandment V is the most important... but it is almost useless if the first 4 have not been obeyed.

Commandment I

Have Great Account History

Total - Search ?	808	13,337	6.06%
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When you open a new Adwords account, everything you do is recorded and could be used against you... only no-one read your adwords Miranda rights:

“ You have the right not to use your account. Anything you do in it will be recorded and can be used against you. You have the right to close your account and open a new one if you've had bad history, provided you haven't infringed any of Google Adwords terms & conditions. ”

Your account's history is the average click-through-rate (CTR) collected for all your campaigns serving the search network in your account.

A completely new account is like a new born baby that hasn't made any mistakes and in that regard the history is good and fresh.

After a few clicks of advertising, a low average CTR on the search network is a sign to Google that you're not a quality advertiser as you don't have what searchers want. You will get Quality Scores no higher than 5/10 for most of the keywords you try to use.

What is considered a poor CTR?

As a rule of thumb, anything below 1% is bad on the search network (content network CTRs do not affect account history).

It is not the longevity of that history that counts, but rather the intensity of recent performance.

For instance, it is better to have very incredibly high CTRs the last 7 days than having average CTRs for a period of 5 years.

That's why a bad account history shouldn't be a big concern as it can be easily build by increasing performance. However, if you've had poor history for a very long period of time, it will feel like climbing a very steep mountain trying to get good performance and a new account usually is a better option to consider.

Symptoms of poor account history

In a healthy account, a new keyword should start with a 5/10 score for the first few min (sometimes a couple of hours) then it should rise to at least 7/10 when the spiders have had time to crawl your website.

In an account that has poor history, all the keywords added will start at 5/10 Quality Score or below and stay at 5/10 or below... regardless of the domain being used.

Remedy

It is better to advertise in a new account than in one that has poor account history but it is possible to bring a bad account in good health by simply advertising with high CTRs.

To do so, choose one keyword that you've had good success with and only advertise for that keyword and that keyword only. The good history that it will gather will give your account a second life.

If you choose to start fresh with a new account, make sure to terminate the old one. It is against Google's terms and conditions to possess multiple adwords accounts, unless those accounts are linked together through a MCC account*.

* My Client Center Accounts (MCC) are special adwords accounts used by Adwords managers or companies wanting to advertise different products in multiple accounts

Commandment II

Have Great Domain History

This is very similar to account history. If you neglect a domain by advertising it on the search network with low CTR, it will acquire bad history.

Fortunately, this is one you can see coming by monitoring your ads carefully. Unfortunately, a domain can have poor history very fast, it doesn't take weeks nor days it can happen within a few hours.

The moment you start advertising with a domain, if you don't have an acceptable CTR after a couple hundred impressions, your score will drop slowly from 7 to 5 then 3 and eventually 2.

That's why every time you start advertising with a new keyword, and a new ad, you cater after it like it was your new born baby and you make sure it breathes and lives properly with high CTR.

Again, anything below 1% is bad on the search network, but you want as high CTRs as you can get, that's what Google likes!

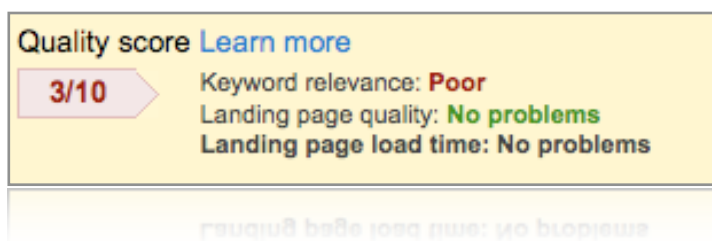
If you can't get a good CTR on particular keyword even after using the methods described the *Writing Irresistible Ads* section, pause it. This is very common for single worded and broad matched keywords that generate high impressions.

SPECIAL CASE: In some markets - and for some keywords - other advertisers have screwed things up for you. When a keyword itself has a reputation of low CTR for all the advertisers who've used it, Google will use that information and give it a low QS for every new advertiser who tries to use it. It's up to you to have that keyword perform well for you and have high QS. When in doubt, talk to an adwords representative, they'll tell you if it's the case or not (*Appendix D*).

Symptoms of poor domain history

Low scores due to poor domain history can be diagnosed in two ways.

First, the diagnostic tool will tell you that your keyword is not very relevant. Hover your mouse over the bubble beside your keyword in the Status column. This is what you'll see:



Second, every keyword you try to advertise with that domain will invariably be given a low score that ranges between 2 to 5.

Remedy

Same as for account history, you can bring your domain in good standing by getting high CTRs advertising with one keyword at a time. This is a good solution in a mild cases of Quality Score drops from 7 to 5 for example.

If the problem is severe, if your scores all range around 2 or 3... then it's best to start fresh! Forget about using that domain in Adwords any longer, say farewell and get a new one. It's life!

This doesn't mean that the domain is bad for other advertising channels like natural traffic so do not discard it completely.

If you've been thinking about changing your website's name this is a great time to do it.

If you have a domain that you've been using for years, that you've built a brand around, you can use the same domain in a .net, .org or other country specific extensions. (I recommend .net)

For example, you're advertising www.IRock.com but nobody clicks your ads because you hadn't read the *Writing Irresistible Ads* section of this book so you get bad history. Your keywords get poor scores and advertising becomes harder than hell.

You simply register www.IRock.net and transfer the pages over to this new domain. You make sure the pages are of quality (see commandment III). You learn how to write magnetic ads and you create new ad groups. Bingo! Your scores are back up.

Now you follow the rules and make sure this new domain doesn't get a bad reputation with Adwords.

IMPORTANT - If you have a domain that is ranking high is the natural search results and has had a poor history with Adwords, use a new domain and follow the commandments. But make sure you restrict the domain from getting indexed by Google or else you might be penalized with duplicate content.

Commandment III

Have Relevant & “High Quality” Landing Pages

This is an easy one, yet one that can be fatal if done wrong.

Let me introduce you to Mr Ad-Bot (sometimes called Spider). Every time you create an ad he’s the one who decides if your page is of quality and if it’s relevant.

Here’s how he does it:



1.
He “crawls” your website



- ✓ Relevant
- ✓ Original
- ✓ Transparent
- ✓ No deceptive practices
- ✓ Navigation

2.
He runs it through the quality checklist



3.
The quality switch is turned ON or OFF.

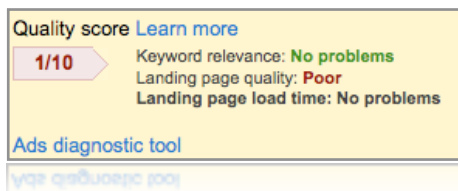
Fig 3. Process of evaluating landing page quality

The Adwords robot crawls your website, runs it through the quality checklist then decides if your site is relevant and of quality. This happens in seconds.

Note. This is the process for ads on the search network and it happens regularly, not just once. Changes you make even after your landing page has been reviewed can cause the switch to be turned “OFF”. It is often backed by real human review of your website but mistakes sometimes happen. Image ads on the content network are usually reviewed by humans only.

Your Quality Score will instantly drop straight to 1/10 without warning if Mr Ad-Bot (or a human reviewer) decides that your website (or landing page - same thing) is of poor quality.

You'll see a message that says *landing page quality: Poor* in the diagnostic tool.



You will not be able to advertise anything with a site that has been plagued with poor site quality.

What Google wants by “landing page quality” may seem a little ambiguous and vague, but it’s actually simple. Some people think that if their website is SEO optimized to have high rankings in natural search results, it will evidently be of high quality for Adwords. That is not completely true, quality for SEO and quality for Adwords are two different things and should be treated separately.

You need to do 4 simple things described below.

Once you’ve done them you need not do anything more to improve landing page quality or relevance.

In other terms, landing page quality and relevance are either good or bad (OK or KO), once Mr Ad-Bot has decided that it’s good, you don’t need to come back and change anything to improve further.

The four simple things you need for landing page quality are:

a) Crawlability

Mr Ad-Bot needs to be able to crawl your website in order to see what it’s about and value its quality.

In general, most websites are crawlable. You may have problems with 100% flash websites, landing pages that only have images and landing pages with javascript links since spiders can't crawl them easily.

If you're really not tech-savvy, you don't know anything about web design and you've hired someone to create your web site or you're using services like Homestead.com... make sure the coding of the pages are search engine friendly.

Some of my clients have had problems with Homestead.com, don't use them.

b) Relevant & original content

The landing page should relate to the keyword, this is pretty logical and I hope you're not thinking about using the keyword "dog food" to send visitors to a landing page about McDonalds. That won't work...

Although the keywords need not be on your landing page, the theme should be relevant.

Check your landing pages with Google's keyword tool before submitting your ads (*see appendix B*). Google will tell you what it thinks your website is about. If the keywords are related to the one you intent to advertise with, then you're good in regards to relevance.

Don't copy. Do your own thing.

You don't have to put hoards of content on your website. You don't have to have 10 pages of articles to have a "high quality" landing page for Adwords. It could be just 10 words, let them just not be copied.

Now, most people think that google only means “text” that is not copied when talking about original content regarding Adwords. But it’s a little more than that...

Having a web site with a little bit of text and a link to an affiliate site is not original content even if the text itself is.

Original means you’re bringing something original to the table regarding a certain searcher’s needs. Something he can’t find anywhere else.

If you own the product you’re advertising, then you own the solution you bring to visitors and that in itself is original since the searcher can’t get it anywhere else but from you.

If you’re an affiliate however, you do not own the product, you do not own the solution and that is not original.

To be original as an affiliate you need to bring value to the searcher, something he can’t find elsewhere. Some affiliates have had success with comparison sites and user-generated reviews. Anyone who believes affiliate marketing is dead with Adwords should type *web hosting review* in Google and see examples of how to make it work. It can be quit a task I admit.

c) Transparency

Have an *about us* page, a *contact us* page and - very important - a *privacy policy*. For the spiders, all they need to see are links to at least those pages, the content almost doesn’t matter... but every website eventually gets a human review and that’s when the content of those pages has to reflect Google’s minimum standards of quality.

Let your visitors know who you are and what the nature of your business is in your *about us* page. Be 100% transparent, if you're getting any kind of commissions from sending your visitors to a parent site, be honest about it and let your visitors know in the *about us*.

Let your visitors know how to contact you in your *contact us* page, show your physical address if you can, an email address, a phone number or a contact form.

Have a *privacy policy* to tell your visitors about information you collect from them. If you are collecting email addresses or any other kind of information, have a link to that privacy policy in close proximity to the form.

Even if you don't collect information directly from the users, the mere fact that you're advertising means that cookies are stored on your visitors computer and for that reason you're also required to have a privacy policy. It doesn't have to be 100% original. You can inspire yourself from one you might have seen from a site of the same nature as yours and you'll be fine.

d) No deceptive practices

Avoid annoying pop-ups, pop-unders, pop-overs, pop-corn or anything else that pops on your landing page. Sometimes they'll fly under the radar, most of the time they won't. My advice: don't use any on the landing page (they're ok on other pages though).

Don't block the back button, don't use iFrames, don't do anything that is tricky or sneaky... just be cool and Google will be cool with you.

On the flip side of deceptive practice, you can have good practices that enhance the users experience on your website like including good navigational links for browsing your website. This is one you

can ignore and still have good Quality Score. You can still put all your links at the bottom of your website and get away with it. But, my predictions are that it won't be long until having great navigational links becomes a strict rule. So start implementing this good habit by having clear navigational links at the top of the page or in the sidebar.

Summary: Relevant and original content, transparency, crawlability, no deceptive practices...

That's all you need for quality. No more, no less.

Symptoms of poor landing pages quality

The only symptom of poor landing page quality (or site quality) is that your Quality Score will suddenly drop to 1/10. If your site is crawlable, you have relevant and original content, you have a privacy/contact/about us page and you're not doing any fishy, then this should not happen.

Unfortunately, it does happen sometimes by mistake.

When it does, here are the steps to take.

Remedy

1. You need to find out the exact reason why your website is deemed to be of poor quality. Look at all the requirements detailed above and try to figure it out. The most common reasons are the lack of the about/contact/privacy pages and crawlability.

If it's not obvious, try to get someone from the Adwords support team on **live chat** so they can tell you exactly why you have a score

of 1/10 (*see appendix D*). They are very helpful and often times they'll help you solve the problem or solve it for you.

Tip. I don't recommend contacting Adwords support by email, it takes time and you'll often get a generic copy & paste response. But if the chat option isn't available for your area then use email.

2. Once you know what the problem is, you have three options:

- Fix it then wait for the spider to crawl your website again. It will take time and if you're not 100% sure about the problem, you're kind of playing with luck.
- Fix it then contact Adwords support team again by chat so they can remove the penalties manually.
- **Recommended** - Fix it on a new domain then create new ad groups for that new domain and resume your advertising. This is the easiest and fastest solution once you know exactly what the problem is. If for example you didn't have the contact/about/privacy combo on your page, then what do is get a new domain, transfer your fixed page over to the new domain, create new ad group(s) and start advertising again.

Commandment IV

Structure Ad Groups by Ad Content Not Keywords

Most people unknowingly create *keyword groups*, not *ad groups*... and that sometimes hinders the power of a strong relation between keywords in an ad group to strengthen its relevance.

There's a reason Google didn't call ad groups *keyword groups*.

Two common mistakes: putting only one keyword per ad group or putting 100 keywords in one ad group. Don't have too little and don't have too many.

I've had great success with 3 to 4 keywords per ad group, more is ok as long as each keyword contributes strengthening the relevance of the ad group. More than 10 becomes too much.

Creating ad groups can almost be considered as the complimentary art to ad writing. Mastery is when you know your market so well that you can picture the person behind each keyword and instantly know which ad in which ad group will create the perfect connection.

One thing that's easy to forget is that behind every keyword is a real person seeking for a solution. It is so easy to see keywords as just words that generate traffic... they are not!

Every keyword has a real person behind it... forget that and you'll go nowhere.

Every person searching on Google has questions he or she needs answers to.

Two searchers may be looking for the same solution but they might describe it in different terms. Your ad groups should segment people by the solution they're looking for and by the terms they use to describe it.

Ad group creation is sometimes straight-forward, sometimes not.

Consider the following example.

Jenna, Carol and Melinda are being harassed by some clueless guy who calls and hangs up using an unknown number (maybe he's just in love and shy, who knows... it's still creepy). They all decide to see if they can trace the number and find out who's calling.

Jenna uses the keyword *mobile phone directory*.

Carol uses *cell phone directory*.

Melinda uses *cell phone lookup*.

They're apparently looking for the same solution, they're using slightly different terms but how would you create ad groups to target them?

You could create one ad group for each keyword. That'd be ok but it's not the best scenario. Keywords in an ad group strengthen each other, the power of the theme* is the core of high ad group relevancy that is key to 10 scores.

You can put all the keywords in one single ad group. That could also work but you'll notice very fast that one keyword isn't in its place and you won't have a powerful theme.

To some people reading this, the solution might be obvious, it wasn't to me at first. Yes, this is a real life example.

* Not to be confused with content network ad group theme

I had an ad group called Cell Phone in which I put all the keywords that had the words *cell phone* in them. Then I had an ad group called Mobile Phone in which I put all the keywords that had the words *mobile phone* in them. Sounds logical, doesn't it?!

Turns out it wasn't the best strategy. I never got my Quality Scores above 7 (that sucks, I know!) until I did this little tweak described below.

The solution was to think about the person behind the keyword and create a message for them before putting them in an ad group.

Once I had my message right, I created an ad group called Phone Directory and one called Phone Lookup.

The difference between Jenna, Carol and Melinda's searches is that Jenna and Carol are thinking about a directory... the terms *mobile phone* and *cell phone* are the same and putting them together in the same ad group strengthens their relevance to the ad.

Melinda however was thinking about performing a *lookup*... a *reverse phone lookup* to be precise. I created an ad group called Reverse Phone Lookup in which I put *cell phone lookup*, *reverse phone lookup* and a few variations.

The results? I finally got my 10s.

Don't underestimate the power of strong ad group structure.

The way to create strong relevant ad groups is by writing one ad first then evaluating each keyword against the message in the ad (as opposed to segmenting the keywords first then writing the ad). If the message in the ad corresponds to the keyword then the keyword has its place in the ad group, if not it corresponds to a different ad group.

I would have created my ad groups correctly from the start had I followed the advice I just gave you.

My ad would have been:

Cell Phone Lookup

Type in any number and
find out who's calling you.

From that ad, it is evident that the message doesn't perfectly correspond to a person looking for a directory.

Commandment V

Get Highest Click-Through-Rates (CTR)

This is where the magic *REALLY* happens. And this is where skill makes *ALL* the difference.

You have learned in the previous pages how CTR affects account history and domain history, what landing page quality means and how to structure ad groups.

When all the first 4 commandments have been obeyed, here's what should happen:

- 1) Your keywords start with Quality Scores of 5. This lasts just enough time for Google to show what the Ad-Bots think of your landing page quality and ad group relevance. Maybe about 30 minutes, usually less.
- 2) Google shows it's judgement of your preliminary quality. It should be 7 or above. Anything below means one of the commandments hasn't been strictly followed*.
- 3) The history clock starts ticking! Everything is now going to be evaluated by the click-through-rates that your ads receive and that click-through-rate will out-weigh everything else that you've done.

You may have a high quality site, you may have structured your ad groups perfectly... if at the end of the day you don't have high CTRs on the search network, your Quality Scores will start going down slowly but surely.

*A rare exception is when all advertisers have had very low performance using a particular keyword, in this case the poor score will be inherent to the keyword itself. Chat with an Adwords representative to confirm.

Actually it can happen very fast! If within 100 impressions your ads don't get clicked, you should be worried. That's why the first few clicks of an ad group's life are very critical. You must have high CTR's from the start and keep improving relentlessly!

If your ads get average CTRs, your scores will stay at about 7 (maybe higher because of strong relevance). If your ads get *ABOVE* average CTR, your scores will jump straight up to perfect 10's. It's like being first in the class. This can be fast too!

Above average CTR means *FAR* better than what the competition is achieving in the same ad auction (fig 2).

Currently, there's no way to know how your ads are performing compared to other advertisers except from seeing your scores skyrocket or plummet... but tools are on their way*.

The secrets to getting higher CTR than the competition is:

- 1) Having irresistible ads
- 2) Having incredibly better targeting

Targeting is very important and very easy to neglect. Don't skip the section on targeting. But... the real area to conquer is ad writing.

If you've been online for any length of time, you understand how important copy writing is. You may have witnessed how changing a single headline on a page can increase your sales dramatically (or may be you haven't).

Ad writing is a great introduction to the wider art of copy writing.

It's fun and very lucrative!

See you in the next chapter...

* Visit: <http://www.google.com/ads/innovations/competition.html>

Successful salesmen are rarely good speech makers. They have few oratorical graces. They are plain and sincere men who know their customers and know their lines. So it is in ad writing.

~ Claude Hopkins, Scientific Advertising



GETTING HIGHER CTRs

WITH IRRESISTIBLE ADS

Lesson 1

Understand Words, Images & Emotions

Ever read an exciting book then got utterly deceived by its film adaptation?

Most books that are turned into movies rarely quite match our expectations. The movie we played in our minds when reading the words is a tough one to compete with.

We human beings think mostly in images. The **words we read** create pictures in our minds and trigger emotions in our bodies. The **words we write** are born from pictures and emotions we try to express.

When we make a search in Google, the unmet need for which we seek a solution to is associated to a mental image and an emotion.

Effective ads trigger images and emotions that match or surpass the ones searchers have just before typing keywords in Google.

James Connor calls this the “*sales moment*” when talking about brand advertising in his excellent book *The Perfection of Marketing**.

So, the first step of writing irresistible ads is discovering the images and emotions behind the keyword. Finding what goes through the searcher’s mind when he or she is sitting in front of the computer typing words in Google.

Lesson 2

Understand Features & Benefits

Understanding the difference between features and benefits is crucial.

Features are attributes, specifications, characteristics of your products and services. They are straight forward facts like the size of your computer screen or the weight of your cellular phone.

Benefits are what the product or its features do for customers, how it makes their lives easier. The chair I’m sitting on right now could be made of hard wood but it has cushions (feature) so my bottom doesn’t hurt after 3 hours (benefit).

Here’s an example taken from Apple’s website about the iPhone 4:



5-Megapixel Camera with LED Flash

Take beautiful, detailed photos with the new 5-megapixel camera with built-in LED flash. The advanced backside illumination sensor captures great pictures even in low light. And the new front-facing camera makes it easy to take self-portraits.

* Source: <http://www.apple.com/iphone/features/>

Features	Benefits
5-megapixel camera	Take beautiful, detailed photos
Advanced backside illuminator sensor	Capture great pictures even in low light
Front-facing camera	Makes it easy to take self-portraits

When writing ads, you'll have to choose whether to make them benefits driven, features driven or a combination of both.

People rationalize their buying decisions with facts but they buy based on emotions.

Cleverly stating facts or features about your product at the right time along with their benefits to trigger the right emotions is key to successful ads. Hence the importance of understanding the Disco Dance.

Lesson 3

Understand The Disco Dance

There are a series of steps a customer goes through before deciding to buy a product from a specific website. Some call it the sales funnel, the buying funnel, the sales process... I call it the Disco Dance: **Discovery, Interest, Study, Comparison, Order.**

Understanding each step of the Disco Dance and finding where a keyword fits in will help you uncover what a searcher really is looking for and the kind of message that will resonate most with him or her. It will help decide whether to write a benefits driven ad, a features driven ad or one that combines both. Let's dance!

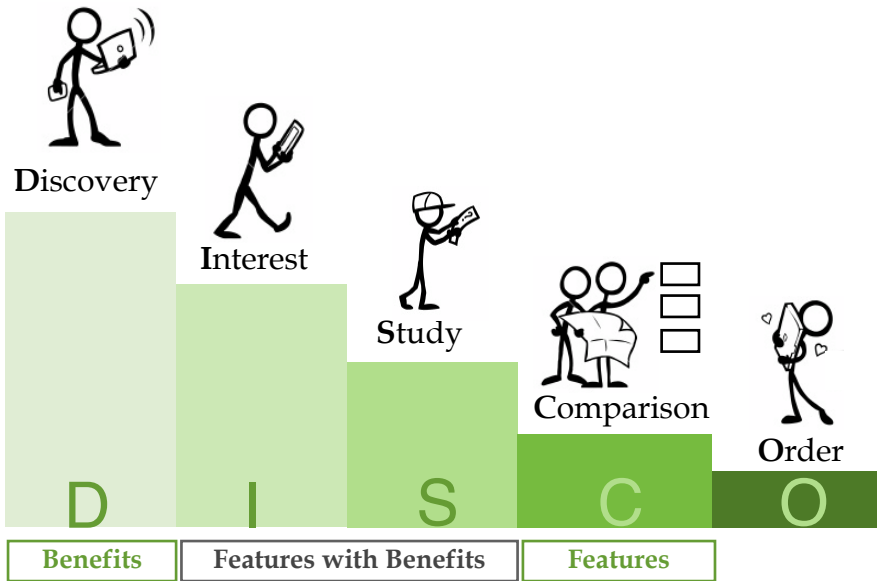


Figure 4. The Disco Dance. The different stages in the buying process. Knowing where a keyword fits in the dance helps in crafting the right message.

Tim is our stick figure and we'll use him to explain the different steps in the Disco Dance.

DISCOVERY Tim becomes aware about his problem. At this stage he doesn't know much about the problem nor the solutions that are available, he uses very general terms to see what's out there.

A benefit driven ad will most likely appeal to him. Tell him how you will solve his problem and make his life so much better. Do not confuse him with industry jargon he might not be familiar with.

INTEREST & STUDY Once he has found the solution you propose and has grown a little (or a lot) of interest from the benefits he knows about, he studies the offer and the offerer. He starts digging

in and gathering more information to help him decide. He uses more specific keywords.

Showing him features is a great choice since he already knows a little about the benefits... but he's still early in the Disco Dance so it's important to showcase benefits as well. An ad showcasing both features and benefits will do well.

COMPARISON At this stage into the dance he knows about quite a lot about the benefits and he has decided to buy. It's now a matter of who he will buy from. He'll compare competitors' features, prices, etc... He uses more specific keywords including comparison terms and product names.

An ad showcasing features and facts about your product will guide him better to the next step which is ordering your product. This is where you need to show what differentiates you from your competitors, better prices maybe, a discount, free shipping, etc.

ORDER He's made his choice, he knows what he wants and gets it.

Sometimes it won't be evident which stage of the Disco Dances a searcher is in. The default is to create an ad with features and benefits then start testing other types to better understand what resonates most with each potential prospect.

When you have found where a keyword fits in the disco dance and you have discovered the mental pictures behind it, time to write the ad.

Features driven ads are pretty straight-forward. You find out the what gives you the competitive edge and put it in the ad.

Most of your ads are going to be benefit driven however, and there are many ways to write them.

Lesson 4

Never Run Out Of Effective Ads To Test

Success with Adwords is all about testing. So never stop testing. Here's how to never run out of successful ads to test.

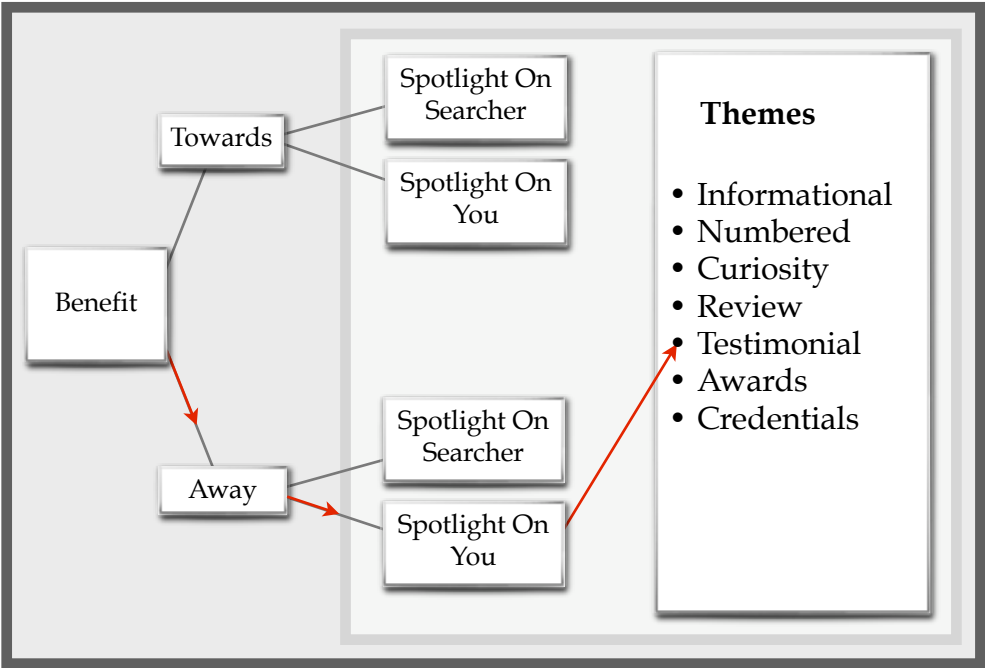


Fig 5 - Combining different perspectives to create new ads

We are always trying to go towards something or away from something. Every benefit you find can be written in the form of going towards something or going away from something. That's the first thing to test when you have found compelling benefits to advertise in your ads.

[Home Based Business](#)

Make Money From Home & Get The Freedom You Want.

Going towards something

[Home Based Business](#)

Quit Your Job & Escape The Boredom Of 9 to 5.

Getting away from something

[Beautiful Clay Projects](#)

Learn How To Create Beautiful Polymer Clay Pieces

Going towards something

[Ugly Clay Projects?](#)

You Will Struggle w/ Poly Clay If You Don't Know These Basics

Getting away from something

In some of the ads you'll write, you can put a twist on them by putting the spotlight on yourself instead of the searcher and tell the story of how you or other people achieved the desired result.

In doing so you can choose to fall into one of the themes that have proven to be effective:

Informational Ads

Searchers are looking for information. Give them information that will lead them into buying your product. This theme is for ads that promise to teach about something:

[Home Based Business](#)

Get 5 tips to creating a home business fast & easy

Spotlight on searcher

[Home Business Secrets](#)

We'll teach you how to create profitable home businesses

Spotlight on you

Ads With Numbers

People are conscious about details. Numbers that convey specific details about the benefits you can provide can turn clicks and conversions in your favor.

[Home Based Business](#)

We've helped 234 People Build A Home Business

[Home Based Business](#)

We've helped 234 People Quit Their Job & Get Freedom

Ads That Peek Curiosity

Can you present your product in an unusual way? Is there something uncommon about your product? Even if there isn't, you can find something that peek people's curiosity and makes people want to learn more.

[Home Based Business](#)

My 2 Yr Old Son Helped Me
Build My Home Business

[Home Based Business](#)

Thanks To My 2 y-o Son I
Finally Quit My Job

As you can see, these themes can also (actually they should) be mixed together to create an endless supply of ads to test and always keep improving performance.

Talking about curiosity, here's one you may have see every where on the web :

[1 Trick To Lose Fat: Obey](#)

Cut 6 lb/week Of Belly Fat
Using 1 Weird Old Trick

Testimonial Ads

Trust is a major factor in the decision making process. Knowing that someone else has tried what you have to offer and got results helps customers trust that what you have works. It also puts a human beings voice in the conversation rather than the formal tone of a company.

[Home Based Business](#)

I make \$300/Day Working
3 Hours From Home.

[Home Based Business](#)

I Finally Quit My Job & Got
The Freedom I Dreamed Of

Review Ads

Review ads are almost like testimonials only they invite users to see them on the website. These might be easily mixed with the other types, but... test them.

[Get Great Quality Scores](#)

See What Others Are Saying
About Ten Scores

[10/10 Quality Scores](#)

Read Expert Reviews About
Ten Scores

Ads With Awards & Credentials

Third party endorsements are very powerful especially where it matters for the consumer. So are credentials in certain field.

[Rated #1 Business Op](#)

Rated #1 Home Based
Business Opportunity In US

[Adwords Professional](#)

Increase Website ROI w/ A
Certified Adwords Pro.

Figure 5 shows the blueprint to different combinations as a basis for conducting test. Not all combinations are possible but there's a lot to choose from.

TRICKS: Special characters and display URL

Adding a question mark to the headline (even when it doesn't make sense) has proven to increase CTR. So is adding special characters:

Trademark Sign TM, Registered Sign [®] when it makes sense to do so.

Treat your display URL like the 4th line of your ad. You can put anything before and after your domain name.

For example, my domain is TenScores.com. In my ads, I can write anything before:

Free.TenScores.com

Trial.TenScores.com

Discount.TenScores.com

Or after the domain:

TenScores.com/**FreeChapter**

TenScores.com/**Promo**

Use words that tell readers what to expect when they land on your page.

Your ads might perform better without using this little trick so don't assume that you should use it every time.

Lesson 5

The Conversion Rate vs CTR Dilemma

So far we've been talking about everything that gets you higher and higher click-through-rates to outperform competitors and get 10/10 Quality Scores.

But the primary goal of your ad isn't to get high CTRs, it is to make you money with high conversion rates. Google doesn't care much about that though, they want high CTRs.

When testing ads performance, watch their CTRs very closely but make final decisions (to pause or not to pause) based on their conversion rates.

The ideal scenario is finding ads that have high CTRs while generating the highest conversions as well. Rarely the case.

You'll have a few ads with low CTRs and high conversion rates and a few ads with high CTRs and low conversion rates.

If you pause the ads with high CTRs, your Quality Score may drop, if you pause the ads with low conversion rates, your ROI may drop.

So what do you do?

You take the best of both worlds.

Keep one ad that has a high CTR and have one that has high conversions. As long as the ad with high CTR is profitable even at low margins, you shouldn't pause it.

If your high CTR ad really is unprofitable then of course you'll have leave it out and keep testing for better ad. A better solution is to start testing a different landing page for that particular ad if it has

significantly higher CTR and lower conversion rates. Assume that you're attracting a different kind of searcher and create landing pages customized to that searcher.

The "F" Word

Adding the word *free* (what did you think I was referring to?) is known to increase CTRs but lower conversions. You'll often hear people suggest that you should never use it because using it attracts freebie seekers who apparently have no interest in spending money.

The truth is people are people and everybody likes free stuff, even those who have money to spend. Rather than banning the word *free*, create a different landing page and provide something of great value in exchange of visitors email for example and see if you can lead them through the Disco Dance seamlessly.

Calls To Action

I'm ashamed of putting this at the end. It should be somewhere at the beginning. Congratulations for reading this far, others won't know about this.

Adding calls to actions like *buy now*, and product prices in your ad might lower CTRs but it will increase your conversion rates as people know what to expect when they arrive on your website. They allow you to attract the right kind of prospect, the ones that are ready to perform the action you want them to.

Test calls to actions vehemently!

Sign up today, get free newsletter today, buy (product name) now, get insider secrets today, try it free now, download now, get free quote today, contact us now, etc...

Find what works best and use it everywhere.

Lesson 6

The Competition Works For You

The most effective method of getting high CTR is understanding how to connect with searchers by discovering the mental pictures that guide their searches. There's no better way to that than researching the natural and sponsored search results.

a - Research the sponsored results

There are a few competitors for your market that have discovered the kind of ads that are good performers. They have already done half the work for you.

Find out the ads that have been running the longest for a particular keyword. There are many tools available to spy on your competitors, read **appendix C** to find out how to do that for free. Whatever tool you use, you want the ability to see how long a particular ad has been running. The longer an ad has been running for a particular keyword, the more likely for it to have a strong CTR.

Your job will be to create ads of your own that perform better.

Looking at competitor's ads gives you a baseline with which to work with, you'll understand where a keyword fits in the Disco Dance and be able to craft the right message.

If there's a competitor that has an ad that exactly matches your products and services, and if that competitor's ad has been running for a very long time, use it to the letter as your control ad.

You may have a legitimate strong opinion about doing such a thing and you can choose not to follow my advice. What I want is for you to succeed, and for that to happen you should know what works. It is easier to piggy back on your competitor's work and improve it

rather than doing it from scratch. In most cases, you'll be able to out-perform a competitor's ad immediately if you understand all the material in this chapter.

b - Research the natural search results

There's a reason why Google is the #1 search engine: they know what users want.

Type your top 3 to 5 keywords in Google. The results you see will tell you a lot about the person behind the keyword and what they're looking for.

Put yourself in the shoes of the searcher, try to imagine the actions that led them to typing in the keyword. Try to imagine the mental pictures they played in their mind.

Look at each website and ask yourself why it is listed as the best result to show to users. What questions are they answering. Do they lead to commercial websites or not?

Now look for websites where your potential customers might be hanging out: blogs, forums, etc

Click on the blog search in the left sidebar of Google and find where people are leaving comments about your keyword.

Answer these questions:

1. What is the #1 concern that people are expressing?
2. Is there a burning question or need that nobody is addressing?

When you have answered those questions, you should have a clear picture of who the searcher behind the keyword is and what they're looking for. When writing your ad, craft a message with benefits that match or surpass the mental images that the searcher had.



Step 1

- Write one targeted ad (one that describes your product best)
- Find best competitors ad (*see Appendix C*)
- Use both of these ads as the first test for your new ad group

Step 2

- Pause losing ad (use free tool at splittester.com)
- Write a new ad using the 6 lessons in the previous chapter

Step 3

- Repeat step 2
- Refine targeting (next chapter)
- When you have 10/10 Quality Scores, go to step 4

Step 4

- Clone the winning ad 4 times
- Create a fifth ad using the 6 lessons in the previous chapter (This allows you to test with minimal effect on CTR)
- Test a new ad regularly

TARGETING



INCREASING CTR

WITH BETTER TARGETING

It is a hot summer afternoon and Maggie can't stand the heat. She works from home and lives on 1126 Shinn Street in New York.

Maggie decides to buy an air fan. After a little research she discovers the cool new dyson air multiplier and she wants it badly.

She types *buy dyson air multiplier* is google.

An ad auction is ran for the sponsored results. 11 advertisers are competing for Maggie's attention.

Now, imagine if one of the advertisers was Maggie's neighbor who's a psychic and happens to sell dyson air multipliers.

He has an ad targeting people who live on Shinn Street in New York

[Maggie's Air Multiplier](#)

Maggie, Come Get Your Dyson Air Fan Next Door & Get Cool

and the ad the says:

Among all the 11 advertisers, what are the chances do you think our psychic's ad will get the click? That ad would probably have 1 impression, 1 click and 100% click-through-rate.

This an extreme case of perfect targeting, not achievable but I hope you understand how the settings and the keywords you choose are the bases of better targeting.

Always think of your ad competing in an ad auction against other ads.

Too much targeting results in very few impressions.

Bad targeting result in high impressions, no clicks.

Great targeting results in higher CTR. Higher CTR results in better Quality Scores. Better Quality Scores result in higher Impression Share. Higher Impression Share results in more impressions, more clicks, more traffic. Do not think that going as wide as possible gets you more traffic, in some cases it actually does the opposite.

The rules of great targeting are:

Rule 1

Choose specific keywords (but don't go overboard)

- Understand the Disco Dance and choose keywords accordingly. Start with keywords that represent people who are at the last stages (comparison, study) of the dance. Avoid single-worded keywords or general phrases (*air fan* vs *dyson air multiplier*) at the beginning as they are too wide and come from searchers who don't really know what they are looking for. Go for key phrases that have 2, 3 or more words in them. Add general keywords only once you know what works and you want to reach audiences that are early in the Disco Dance.
- Use match types* accordingly. Always start with exact matched keywords in ad groups then monitor their

* Visit: <http://adwords.google.com/support/aw/bin/answer.py?hl=en&answer=6100>

performance. If you have good CTRs or if the keywords don't generate enough impressions, add the same keywords in phrase match (add negative keywords too) then monitor their performance. Add broad match if you see good performance and watch performance even closer, broad match are known to have very low CTRs unless they're combined with a great list of negative keywords. Pause anything that performs poorly (i.e. less than 1%). Any ad groups where you have phrase or broad matched keywords, always have negative keywords as well . When having the same keyword in different match types, exact match should have the higher bid, broad match should have the lowest bid, the phrase match bid should be in the middle.

Rule 2

Be specific in campaign settings (but don't go overboard)

Important campaign settings are *network targeting*, *location targeting* and *device targeting*.

Network Targeting

Always separate search network from content network in different campaigns. In search network, there's the Google.com and the search partners. You can optionally separate them too in different campaigns. What I personally do is have them in the same campaign at the beginning then watch their individual performances. I separate them later if I find that they have very different CTRs or conversions.

Location Targeting

Google judges your performance in regards to the location where your ads are appearing. Do not target all countries ever for any campaign. Choose the best regions where your ads should appear. In highly competitive markets, do not go wider

than one country per campaign. Run geographic reports in the reporting center to see which regions are performing better than others (if any) and target those regions specifically.

Device Targeting

Your ads can show on computers or mobile devices that have full browser capabilities (iphones, etc). In the beginning, choose both and monitor their performances, if you find a significant difference you should create different campaigns for each.

Final Words

By now you should have a clear path in your mind of the actions to take to increase your scores... that's if you haven't started taking those actions yet.

It may seem like hard work doing every step for each keyword you have but it's not. Only 20% of your keywords will account for 80% of your revenue so those are the keywords to focus on.

If you follow the steps systematically, with time you'll start getting 10/10 quality scores without realizing it and with very little effort on your part.

Whatever you do, come back to this book ever time you see a Quality Score drop and never neglect that little number... the success of your advertising depends a lot on it.

Do not forget to email me your successes with this book, ideas, comments or complaints. I want to know what you think.

Email me at: *chris@tenscores.com*

I wish you the best of luck!

Chris Thunder

Appendix A: Customizing columns

Viewing Quality Score & Impression Share

VIEW QUALITY SCORE

1. Click on the keywords tab
2. Click columns
3. Make sure Qual. Score is checked, then save.

The screenshot shows the Google Ads interface with the 'Keywords' tab selected. A red arrow labeled '1' points to the 'Keywords' tab. Another red arrow labeled '2' points to the 'Columns' button. A third red arrow labeled '3' points to the 'Qual. Score' checkbox in the 'Performance' section of the 'Select columns' dialog. The 'Preview' section on the right, enclosed in a red box labeled 'Optional', shows a list of columns that can be reordered, including 'Clicks', 'Impr.', 'CTR', 'Avg. CPC', 'Cost', 'Avg. Pos.', and 'Conv. (1-per-click)'.

You should now have a column that shows your Quality Score for each of your keywords on the search network.

Note: Quality Score cannot be viewed for content network campaigns.

Optional: Since Quality Score is critical you should reorder the columns to have it be the column just beside your keywords.

VIEW IMPRESSION SHARE

1. Click on the Campaigns tab
2. Click columns
- 3 Make sure Competitive metrics is checked, then save.

The screenshot shows the Google Ads interface. At the top, the 'Campaigns' tab is selected. Below it, the 'Columns' menu is open, showing a list of metrics. The 'Competitive metrics' checkbox is checked. A red arrow points to the 'Columns' menu, and another red arrow points to the 'Competitive metrics' checkbox. A third red arrow points to the 'Impr. Share' checkbox. The 'Preview' section on the right shows the 'Impr. Share' metric selected.

Select columns

- ☐ Performance
- ☒ Clicks
- ☒ Impr.
- ☒ CTR
- ☒ Avg. CPC
- ☐ Avg. CPM
- ☒ Cost
- ☐ Avg. Pos.
- ☐ Invalid Clicks
- ☐ Invalid Click Rate
- ☐ Conversions
- ☒ Conv. (1-per-click)
- ☒ Cost / conv. (1-per-click)
- ☒ Conv. rate (1-per-click)
- ☒ View-through
- ☐ Conv. (many-per-click)
- ☐ Cost / conv. (many-per-click)
- ☐ Conv. rate (many-per-click)
- ☐ Total conv. value
- ☐ Value / conv. (1-per-click)
- ☐ Value / conv. (many-per-click)
- ☒ Competitive metrics
- ☒ Impr. Share
- ☒ Lost Impr. Share (Budget)
- ☒ Lost Impr. Share (Rank)

Preview
Drag and drop to reorder

- Campaign
- Budget
- Status
- Clicks
- Impr.
- CTR
- Avg. CPC
- Cost
- Conv. rate (1-per-click)
- Conv. (1-per-click)

You should now have a column that shows your Impression share for each of campaigns.

Note: Impression share is only viewable at the campaigns level and is only available for search network campaigns.

Quality Score and Impression Share are not the only metrics you can customize your account to show, hopefully you've been using or are interested in using Conversion tracking to view your conversion metrics too.

Appendix B: Landing Page Relevance

See What Google Thinks Your Page Is About

1. Visit <https://adwords.google.com/select/KeywordToolExternal> or go to Opportunities > Tools > Keyword Tool in your Adwords account.

2. Enter your landing page url in the website field and click search.

3. See if the keywords really correspond to your page. They don't have to be the exact same keywords you intend to use but they should clearly be related.

Find keywords
Based on one or both of the following:

Word or phrase (one per line)

Website

☐ Advanced options Locations: United States Languages: English

All Categories

- ☐ Apparel
- ☐ Beauty & Personal Care
- ☐ Computers
- ☐ Consumer Electronics
- ☐ Family & Community
- ☐ Finance
- ☐ Food
- ☐ Gifts
- ☐ Health
- ☐ Hobbies
- ☐ Home
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Products
- ☐ Media & Events

Keyword ideas

Keyword	Competition	Global Monthly Searches
☐ science of getting rich audio	☐	1,000
☐ the science of getting rich wallace	☐	1,900
☐ science of getting rich bob proctor	☐	590
☐ the science of getting rich audio	☐	1,000
☐ the science of getting rich book	☐	720
☐ the new science of getting rich	☐	14,800
☐ the science of getting rich cd	☐	46

Spying on Competition

There are a variety of tools that have the capacity of showing you which ads, landing pages and keywords your competitors have been using.

This kind of competitive intelligent can be very useful when you want to advertise with a new keyword. Knowing what is already working helps you put the guess work out of the way and get high CTRs right from the start.

Whatever tool you choose to use, make sure it shows you the number of days a particular ad has been running. The assumption being that if an ad has been seen for a long time, it means it is performing well.

The tool we'll use in this example is KeywordSpy.com as you can get enough information with their free version, you shouldn't need any more.

1. Go to KeywordSpy.com and type a keyword in the search bar. Make sure the *keywords* button is selected.

2. Choose the country for which want to research and hit *Search*.

You'll be presented with an overview of the competitive land-field for that keyword and you can look through it if you want.

3. Click on the *Ads* tab. You'll see a list of all the ads that have been shown for that keyword and the number of days they have been seen.

When you create your new ad group, take one of those ads and use it as a beginning test. I would tell you not to copy it verbatim and just inspire yourself. The truth is what works is to copy one ad verbatim and use the lessons in the *Writing Irresistible Ads* section to build an ad that has better performance for you in the long run.

DO NOT run a competitor's ad for a long time, it's not an effective long term strategy. Only use it to avoid getting low CTRs in the beginning. Remember, low CTR could kill your campaigns.

1

2

HomeResearchTrackingPricingFree TrialDownload Plug-InLive ChatHelp

Welcome, guest | Sign in | Make a FREE Trial

KeywordSpy

competitive research

United States

Search

DomainsKeywordsDestination URLsAd Copies

Keyword: competitive research

Vol: 12,100/moCPC: \$2.96

OverviewAds (46)Related (964)Similar (12)Misspell (0)PPC Competitors (26)Organic Competitors (20)

Search Results: 1 - 10 out of 46 ads

No.	Ad Copy	ROI ↑	Affiliate	Position	Days Seen	Last/First Seen
1.	Competitive Research Find out who is sending the most traffic to your competitors! ci.trellian.com	267	N/A	Last: 4 Avg: 4.0	290/316 days	22 Jun, 06:12 AM 11 Aug, 02:27 PM
2.	Competitive Intelligence Get Online, In-Depth Business and Public & Private Company Info. business.com	227	Business.com	Last: 15 Avg: 7.0	267/315 days	22 Jun, 06:12 AM 12 Aug, 03:20 PM
3.	Web-based CI Dashboard Benchmark & monitor competitors. Pricing analysis. Free trial. primary-intel.com	192	N/A	Last: 3 Avg: 2.0	246/316 days	22 Jun, 06:12 AM 11 Aug, 02:27 PM
4.	Marketing Intelligence See what your competitors are doing and demonstrate your market knowl...	134	N/A	Last: 5 Avg: 5.0	206/316 days	22 Jun, 06:12 AM 11 Aug, 03:27 PM

Appendix D: Find Help For Tough Situations

Chatting With Reps

This is one of the greatest thing you can do when you need a little help with tough issues.

Adwords support has a chat feature where you can have live assistance from official adwords representatives. They will look at your adwords account from their end and they will give you insights you wouldn't have discovered otherwise.

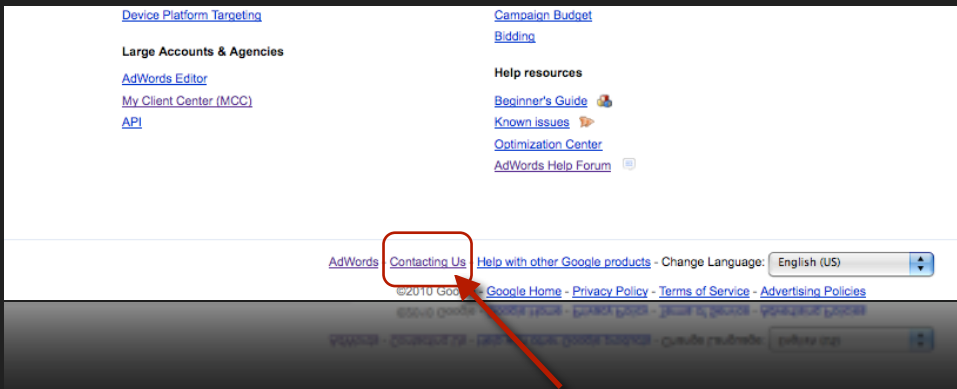
The problem is that its a feature that is not available all the time and not everywhere.

To get live help follow these instructions:

1. In your adwords account, click *Help* in the top right corner.



2. The help page will open. At the very bottom, click *Contacting Us*.



3. You'll see their contact page which starts with more help articles for solving common issues. Browse through some of them.

4. Look at the bottom of the help articles, they will have additional contact options: the help forum, email and... CHAT.

Important:

- The chat option doesn't appear below all the help articles so browse through a few of them to see.
- The chat feature only appears when someone is available at Google to chat.
- The chat feature is not available in every country.

The screenshot shows the 'Contact Us' page of Google AdWords. A red box with the number '3' points to the 'Payment Options' link in the left sidebar. Another red box with the number '4' points to the 'Chat with an AdWords Specialist' link in the 'Have additional questions?' section. The page content includes a list of help articles on the left, a main article titled 'Can I switch my account between payment options? (India only)' on the right, and a section for additional questions at the bottom.

Contact Us

- Ad Visibility, Approvals, and Performance
- Campaigns and Ads
- Billing and Cost Control
 - Payment Options
 - Can I switch my currency after setting up my account? »
 - How do I update my billing information (India only)? »
 - Where can I get a standing instruction form? (India only)
 - Can I switch my account between payment options? (India only) »
- Promotional Codes
- Settings, Budgets, and Bids
- Invoices, Charges, and Payment Difficulties
- VAT
- Account Administration
- Google Analytics, Conversion Tracking, AdWords Editor
- Provide Feedback

Can I switch my account between payment options? (India only)

You can switch between available postpay options or between available prepay options at any time. However, you can't switch between prepay and postpay options at any time.

I. Between prepay options

You can switch your account between prepay options at any time. Learn to switch from [net banking to cheque or debit card](#) or vice versa.

[See a list of frequently asked questions about India prepay options.](#)

II. Between a prepay and a postpay option

It's not yet possible to switch from a postpay option to a prepay option and vice versa (e.g., from bank transfer to credit card). If you need to switch, you'll need to [close your existing AdWords account and create another](#) with your preferred payment method.

If you decide to close your account and open a new one, please remember to use a different email address. Or, if you can't, you can [substitute it](#) in your existing AdWords account before closing the account.

Remember, available payment methods depend on the country of your billing address and your selected currency. See the [Options page](#) to see what's available to you.

Have additional questions?

- [Post your question](#) on the AdWords Help Forum
The AdWords Help Forum community is supported by Google, advertisers and AdWords experts.
- [Email AdWords Support](#)
We'll respond to your email as soon as possible, typically within one business day.
- [Chat with an AdWords Specialist](#)
Get instant help using online chat.



Chat with an AdWords Specialist
Get instant help using online chat.